Teacher and cover plan — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Audit your developing architectural relief panel against three criteria: structural balance, relief depth, and tonal contrast.

• Exchange one specific peer diagnostic using the 'Strength / Target / Test' protocol.

• Build a quick material test swatch before applying the improvement to your main panel.

Studio kit: Week 2-3 relief panels, critique diagnostic cards, scrap greyboard swatch tiles, corrugated/smooth card, foil, dark wash, dry-brush chrome/chalk

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Look at your relief panel from Week 3. When you prop it upright and step back two metres, which part is clearest and which part fades away?

Starter question: Why do professional studio makers test a new paint mix or foil texture on a small scrap swatch before putting it straight onto their main piece?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Run the two-metre stand-up audit: I prop my panel up, step back, and note on my critique card: 'Strength: strong arch. Target: left pillar blends into background.'

Step 2: Build a 6 cm test swatch: On a small greyboard scrap, I test adding a corrugated backing strip and a bright chalk flange line.

Step 3: Apply the verified upgrade to the panel: Seeing the swatch pop, I laminate the ridged strip and chalk edge onto my main panel's left pillar.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Critique card ticked, test swatch mounted in log, and upgrade applied to main panel.

Independent: Peer critique recorded, swatch tested and mounted, main panel upgraded and annotated.

Aspire: Two comparative swatches, resolved panel refinement, and critical reflection.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Pre-cut 6 cm x 6 cm greyboard swatch squares so every pupil can run a quick material test before modifying their main panel.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to structure a calm, two-minute 'Strength / Target / Swatch' peer critique in

the studio.